

SĀṂKHYA

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE → KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF → THREE GUṆAS → TWENTY-FIVE TATTVAS → SATKĀRYAVĀDA → WHY MANY PURUṢAS?

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE

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SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS

PRAKṚTI PURUṢA ONE, UNCONSCIOUS, PRODUCTIVE MANY, CONSCIOUS, INACTIVE WITNESSES

SĀṂKHYA = SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SĀṂKHYA = SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS
- PRAKṚTI PURUṢA one, unconscious, productive many, conscious, inactive witnesses avyakta equilibrium of guṇas uncaused, unchanging, non-agent apparent association

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- discrimination ends bondage.
- SĀṂKHYA = SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PRAKṚTI PURUṢA one, unconscious, productive many, conscious, inactive witnesses avyakta equilibrium of guṇas uncaused, unchanging, non-agent apparent association
- discrimination ends bondage.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Sāṁkhya (the enumerative dualist school) is a realist dualism in which three pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge) establish one unconscious Prakṛti (primordial material nature) and many conscious Puruṣas (pure witnesses).".

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Sāṁkhya (the enumerative dualist school) is a realist dualism in which three pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge) establish one unconscious Prakṛti (primordial material nature) and many conscious Puruṣas (pure witnesses).".

01

STAGE 01

KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF PRAKṚTI

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THREE PRAMĀṆAS

RELIABLE TESTIMONY PRAKṚTI IS INFERRED, NOT ORDINARILY PERCEIVED FINITE

EFFECTS SHARE COMMON FEATURES COORDINATED WORLD REQUIRES COMMON SOURCE

EVOLUTES NEED AN UNEVOLVED GROUND PLEASURE/PAIN/DULLNESS IN EFFECTS

SATTVA/RAJAS/TAMAS IN CAUSE

BEGINNINGLESS, UNMANIFEST, INDEPENDENT MATERIAL CAUSE

NOT "MATTER" ALONE, BUT PSYCHOPHYSICAL SOURCE OF INTELLECT, SENSES

THREE PRAMĀṆAS: perception

reliable testimony prakṛti is inferred, not ordinarily perceived finite effects require cause → effects share

world requires common source → evolutes need an unevolved ground pleasure/pain/dullness in effects → sattva/rajas/tamas

PRAKṚTI: beginningless, unmanifest, independent material cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- THREE PRAMĀṆAS: perception
- reliable testimony prakṛti is inferred, not ordinarily perceived finite effects require cause → effects share common features coordinated

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- world requires common source → evolutes need an unevolved ground pleasure/pain/dullness in effects → sattva/rajas/tamas in cause
- PRAKṚTI: beginningless, unmanifest, independent material cause

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- not "matter" alone, but psychophysical source of intellect, senses and elements.
- THREE PRAMĀṆAS: perception

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Prakṛti (primordial material nature) is the one unmanifest material root whose three guṇas (constituent qualities)—illumination, activity and restraint—explain both psychological and cosmic diversity through changing proportions.".

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02

STAGE 02

THREE GUṆAS

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SATTVA LIGHTNESS

PRAKṚTI EQUILIBRIUM BREAKS

RAJAS ----- TAMAS ACTIVITY

PAIN INERTIA

DULLNESS GUṆAS ARE CONSTITUENTS, NOT DETACHABLE QUALITIES MUTUAL DOMINATION

SATTVA lightness

PRAKṚTI equilibrium breaks

RAJAS ----- TAMAS activity

pain inertia

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SATTVA lightness
- PRAKṚTI equilibrium breaks

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RAJAS ----- TAMAS activity
- pain inertia

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- dullness guṇas are constituents, not detachable qualities mutual domination + support + production drive all manifest difference.
- SATTVA lightness

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): "Puruṣa (the pure conscious witness) is inactive, non-objectifiable and distinct from every product of Prakṛti, while jīva (the empirical embodied self) is Puruṣa apparently identified with intellect, ego and the subtle body.".

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SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SATTVA lightness
- PRAKRṬI equilibrium breaks

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RAJAS ----- TAMAS activity
- pain inertia

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- dullness guṇas are constituents, not detachable qualities mutual domination + support + production drive all manifest difference.
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03

STAGE 03

TWENTY-FIVE TATTVAS

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PRAKRṬI (1)

BUDDHI (2)

AHAṂKĀRA (3)

MANAS (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS

5 TANMĀTRAS

5 MAHĀBHŪTAS

RĀJASA SUPPLIES ACTIVITY TO BOTH BRANCHES

PRAKRṬI (1)

MAHAT / BUDDHI (2)

AHAṂKĀRA (3)

sāttvika → MANAS (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS

tāmasa → 5 TANMĀTRAS → 5 MAHĀBHŪTAS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PRAKRṬI (1)
- MAHAT / BUDDHI (2)
- AHAṂKĀRA (3)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- sāttvika → MANAS (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS
- tāmasa → 5 TANMĀTRAS → 5 MAHĀBHŪTAS
- rājasa supplies activity to both branches

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PURUṢA (25) stands outside the evolute chain as witness
- COUNT CONTROL: 1 prakṛti + 23 evolutes + puruṣa = 25 tattvas.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (CORE ARGUMENT): “Satkāryavāda (the theory that the effect pre-exists potentially in its cause) and parināmavāda (real transformation) make the evolution of twenty-five fundamental principles a manifestation of determinate causal powers rather than creation from non-being.”.

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04

STAGE 04

SATKĀRYAVĀDA

EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE ASADAKARAṆĀT

NON-BEING CANNOT BE PRODUCED UPĀDĀNAGRAHAṆĀT

SPECIFIC MATERIAL CAUSE IS SELECTED SARVASAMBHAVĀBHĀVĀT

NOT EVERYTHING ARISES FROM EVERYTHING ŚAKTASYA ŚĀKYAKARAṆĀT

CAUSE PRODUCES ONLY WHAT IT HAS POWER TO PRODUCE

EFFECT SHARES NATURE OF CAUSE PARINĀMAVĀDA

REAL TRANSFORMATION OF PRAKRṬI

NYĀYA ĀRAMBHAVĀDA

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaraṇāt: non-being cannot be produced upādānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not
- everything arises from everything śaktasya śakyakaraṇāt: cause produces only what it has power to produce karaṇabhāvāt: effect shares

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- nature of cause parināmavāda: real transformation of prakṛti
- NYĀYA ārambhavāda: new effect

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ADVAITA vivarta: apparent transformation.
- EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaraṇāt: non-being cannot be produced upādānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (FINAL VERDICT): “The power of Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) lies in connecting epistemology, material continuity, empirical consciousness and liberation within one system; its weakness is that the relation required to connect its two absolutes remains under-explained.”.

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05

STAGE 05

WHY MANY PURUṢAS?

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PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE COMPOSITES SERVE ANOTHER

EXPERIENCE NEEDS CONSCIOUS WITNESS OBJECTS OF THREE GUṆAS REQUIRE

LIBERATION IS CONCEIVABLE

BIRTHS/DEATHS DIFFER; SENSE CAPACITIES AND ACTIONS ARE UNCOORDINATED

IF ONE PURUṢA, ONE PERSON’S LIBERATION OR PAIN WOULD

CONTACT PROBLEM

INACTIVE CONSCIOUSNESS CANNOT LITERALLY TOUCH UNCONSCIOUS PRAKRṬI ANALOGIES

PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another

experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experiencer

liberation is conceivable

PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another
- experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experiencer
- liberation is conceivable

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated
- if one puruṣa, one person's liberation or pain would belong to all
- CONTACT PROBLEM: inactive consciousness cannot literally touch unconscious prakṛti analogies: blind-and-lame cooperation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- magnet and iron pressure remains: how does mere proximity begin purposive evolution?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another | experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experiencer | liberation is conceivable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CRITICISM): “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) integrates psychology, cosmology and liberation without a creator God, yet guṇa-explanation risks elasticity, Puruṣa-plurality lacks a clear individuator, and mere proximity does not fully solve the contact problem.”.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another
- experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experiencer
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ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

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MECHANISM / VERDICT

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CRITICISM): “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) integrates psychology, cosmology and liberation without a creator God, yet guṇa-explanation risks elasticity, Puruṣa-plurality lacks a clear individuator, and mere proximity does not fully solve the contact problem.”.

06

STAGE 06

BONDAGE, LIBERATION AND CRITIQUE

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BUDDHI'S STATES ARE APPROPRIATED AS "I" BY REFLECTED CONSCIOUSNESS

REPEATED EMBODIMENT TATTVA-JÑĀNA

"I AM PURUṢA, NOT PRAKṚTI OR ITS EVOLUTES" PRAKṚTI

CEASES ACTIVITY FOR THAT PURUṢA

UNCONSCIOUS PRAKṚTI CANNOT ACT FOR AN END; DUALISM CANNOT

SĀṂKHYA REPLY

TELEOLOGY IS IMMANENT, AS MILK FLOWS FOR CALF; NO

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- AVIVEKA: buddhi's states are appropriated as "I" by reflected consciousness experience + karmic dispositions → repeated embodiment tattva-jñāna
- / viveka-khyāti: "I am puruṣa, not prakṛti or its evolutes" prakṛti has been seen → ceases activity for

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- that puruṣa → KAIVALYA
- ŚĀṂKARA: unconscious prakṛti cannot act for an end; dualism cannot explain contact

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- SĀṂKHYA REPLY: teleology is immanent, as milk flows for calf; no creator is needed.
- AVIVEKA: buddhi's states are appropriated as "I" by reflected consciousness experience + karmic dispositions → repeated embodiment tattva-jñāna

MECHANISM / VERDICT

(CRITICISM): "Kaivalya (liberating isolation of consciousness) follows from viveka-jñāna (discriminative knowledge), but the system's hardest burden is explaining how inactive consciousness and unconscious nature can sustain coordinated, purposive experience.”.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

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07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

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START WITH DUALISM AND THREE GUṆAS

PROVE PRAKṚTI AND PLURAL PURUṢAS

DRAW EXACT 25-TATTVA CASCADE

DEFEND SATKĀRYAVĀDA WITH FIVE REASONS

DISTINGUISH PARIṆĀMA FROM ĀRAMBHA/VIVARTA

EXPLAIN AVIVEKA AND KAIVALYA

TEST CONTACT AND TELEOLOGY OBJECTIONS

START with dualism and three guṇas → prove prakṛti and plural puruṣas

draw exact 25-tattva cascade → defend satkāryavāda with five reasons

distinguish pariṇāma from ārambha/vivarta

explain aviveka and kaivalya → test contact and teleology objections

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- START with dualism and three guṇas → prove prakṛti and plural puruṣas
- draw exact 25-tattva cascade → defend satkāryavāda with five reasons

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- distinguish pariṇāma from ārambha/vivarta
- explain aviveka and kaivalya → test contact and teleology objections

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature
- is its hard problem.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY

IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED PROOF BURDEN AND COGNITION

ITS THREE ACCEPTED PRAMANAS.

THIS ECONOMY CREATES A BURDEN

IMPERCEPTIBLE PRAKṚITI AND PURUṢA CANNOT SIMPLY BE ASSERTED.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced proof burden and cognition model Sāṃkhya reduces comparison, postulation, non-apprehension and tradition to

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- its three accepted pramanas.
- This economy creates a burden: imperceptible Prakṛiti and Puruṣa cannot simply be asserted.
- Samanyato-drsta inference must reach entities never presented as ordinary sense-objects.
- Carvaka attacks the unobserved universal relation, while Nyaya grants inference but proposes atoms and Isvara as a more economical explanation.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Sāṃkhya replies that material continuity, guṇa-patterns and the objectifiability of experience jointly require one material root and a
- distinct witness.
- Empirical cognition occurs through the inner instrument.
- Manas coordinates, ahamkara appropriates and buddhi determines.

OPTIONAL STATUS

This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.